

Element L

This project, though simple in principle, had far more nuance than I think any of us thought beforehand. Perhaps due to the human element inherent in the design of such a solution, none of our members were quite prepared for the difficulties that come with trying to figure out what someone else is thinking. Unfortunately, our group was composed of precisely zero psychics, so we needed to rely on guesswork and body language to figure out the will of our primary stakeholder, mr. Kiser. One tip for anyone trying to create something for mr. Kiser: the more he tries something out or repeats it, the more attention he's trying to draw to that specific element of the design. This was especially clear when watching other groups, not just our own, since the aura of generally cynical humor that mr. Kiser normally projects often hinders those close to him from noticing the nuances that he is trying to draw attention to.

For our product specifically, there are only three improvements which I would like to see made before the handle actually gets used: Some variety of gripping surface, secured inner poles, and improved aesthetics. The gripping surface could easily be solved with just a simple wrapping similar to the handlebars of a grip, and the secured inner poles would be done with just some five minute epoxy, but the aesthetics have proven themselves far more challenging. For one, we don't know what type of look what mr. Kiser would prefer for this handle, but the more pressing concern is budget. We chose PVC specifically because it was cheap, and just about any better looking material would cost more. One possibility is to use black PVC pipe and bend it around the corners instead of using fittings, or to fully cover our existing product with either a wrap or paint, excluding the actual gripping surface.

If whoever next takes this project on wants to go farther, then I would recommend adjustability as a feature. We have considered cotter pins and telescoping systems with collars, but were unable to implement them within our given timeframe. Good luck!